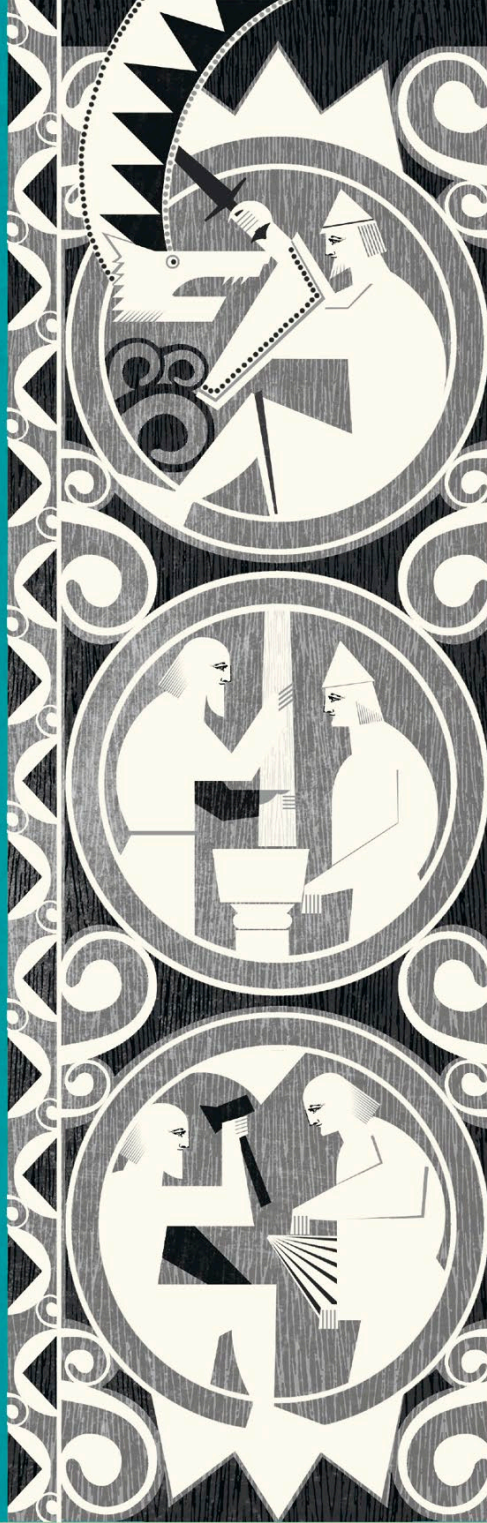


PICTURE CARVINGS

While most ancient cultures wrote on paper, parchment or papyrus (an early form of plant-based paper), the Vikings carved images and letters from their Old Norse alphabet onto stone and wood. This helped to immortalize their myths and stories, and the characters and creatures who appeared in them.

The story of Sigurd and the dragon was carved into a church doorway in Hylestad, Norway, around 800 years ago.



Snakes and serpentine dragons are common in Norse mythology. There is a carving of a Viking fighting a snake at City Hall in Norway's capital, Oslo.

TELLING THE STORIES

The Vikings created incredible stories filled with interesting characters. Some tales are funny, others tragic, many are epic and action-packed, others simply strange. These stories were not written down and read from a book at first. Instead they were remembered, spoken aloud, and passed down by word of mouth to each generation. The Vikings believed that Odin himself had given them the gift of storytelling.